

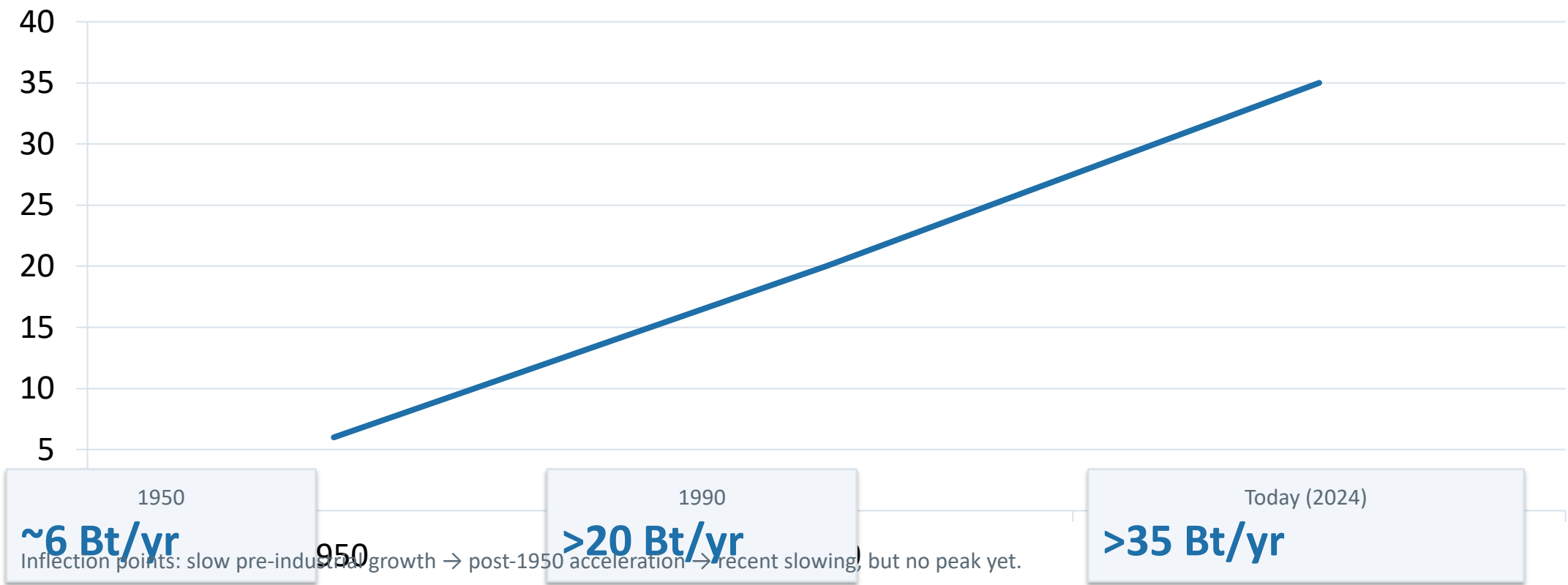
Global CO₂ Emissions: Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

Fossil fuels & industry • 1750–2024

Data: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

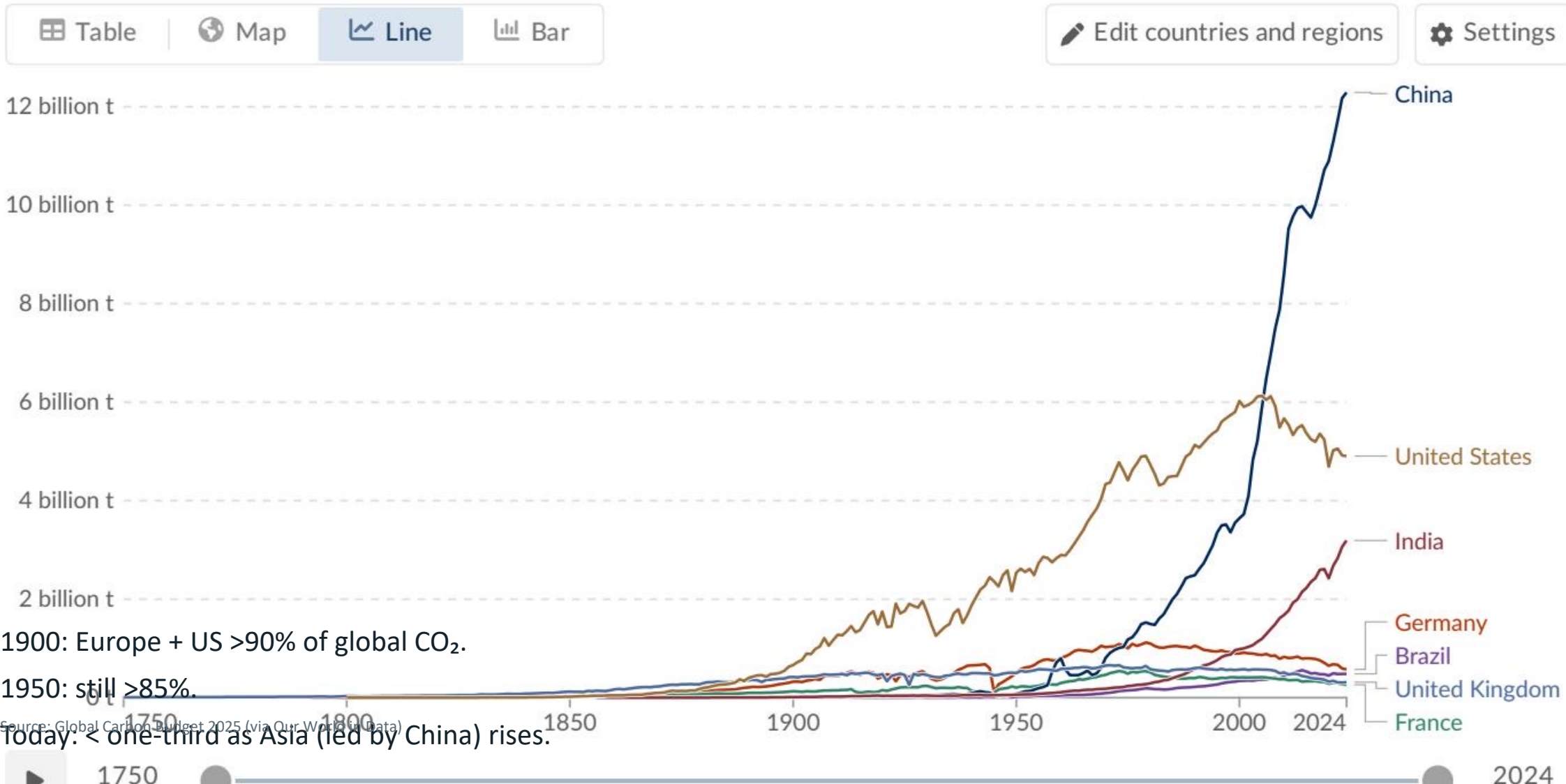
Global CO₂ Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today

Global CO₂ (fossil fuels & industry)

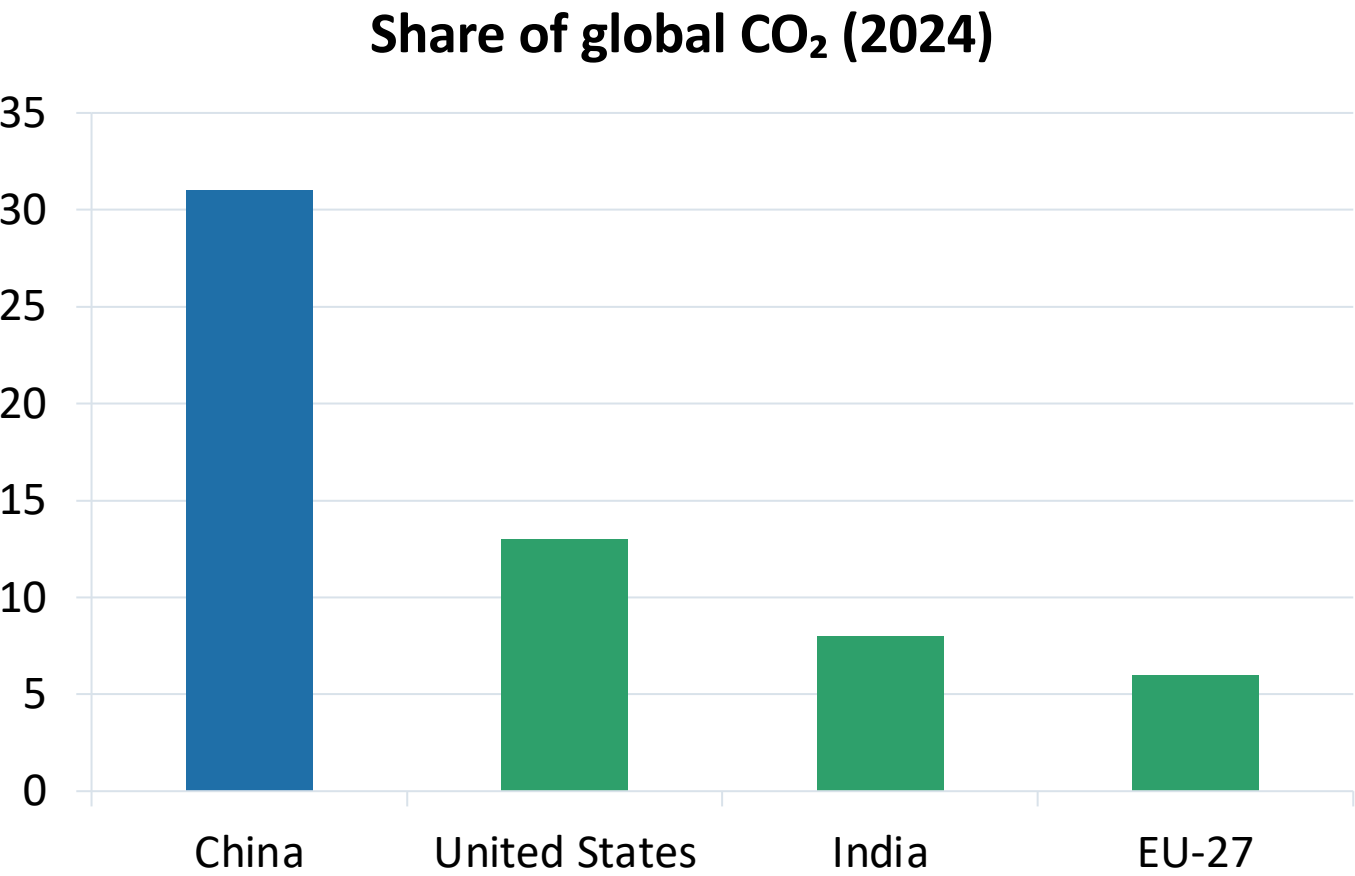


Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 (via Our World in Data)

Europe and the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under One-Third



China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global CO₂

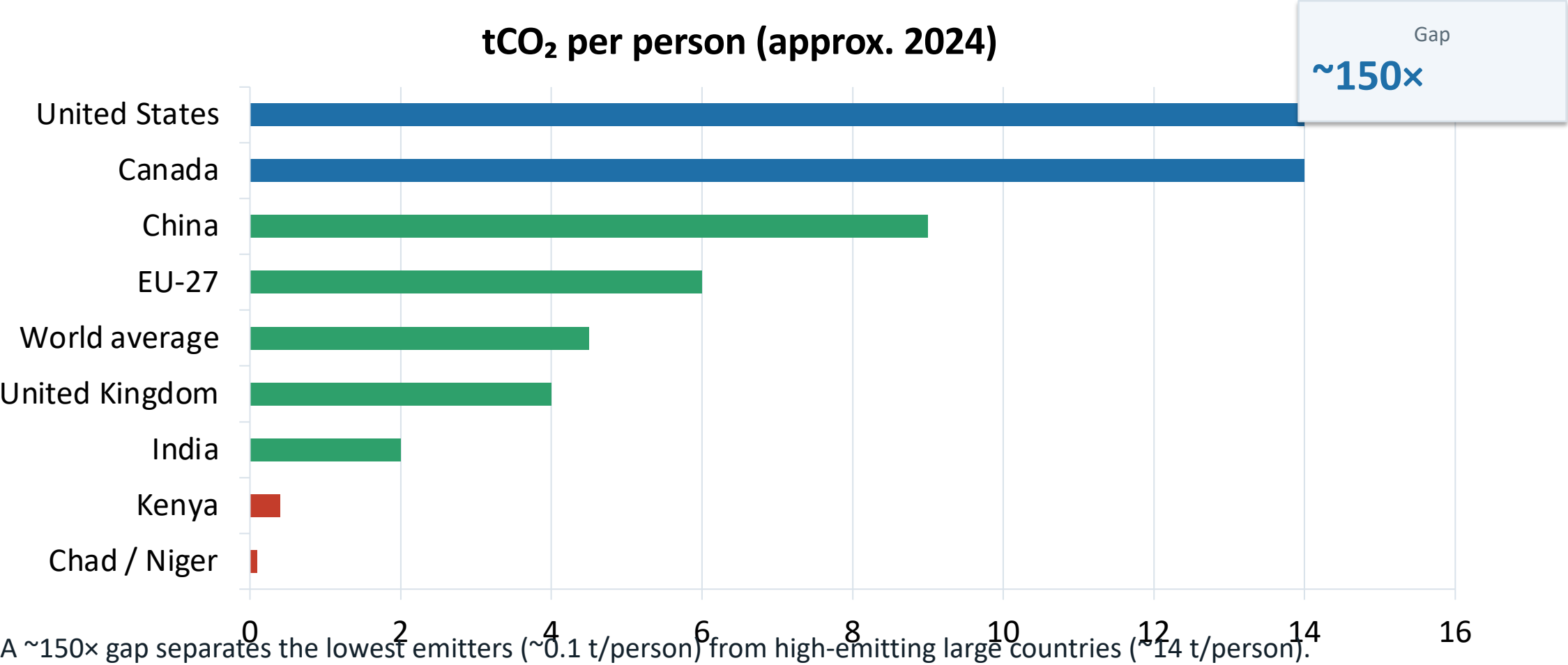


2024
China ~31%

Also notable (from brief)

Russia ~5% (roughly stable)
Africa total ~3–4% (slowly rising)
South America total ~3–4% (roughly stable)
Int'l aviation & shipping ~3% (rising)

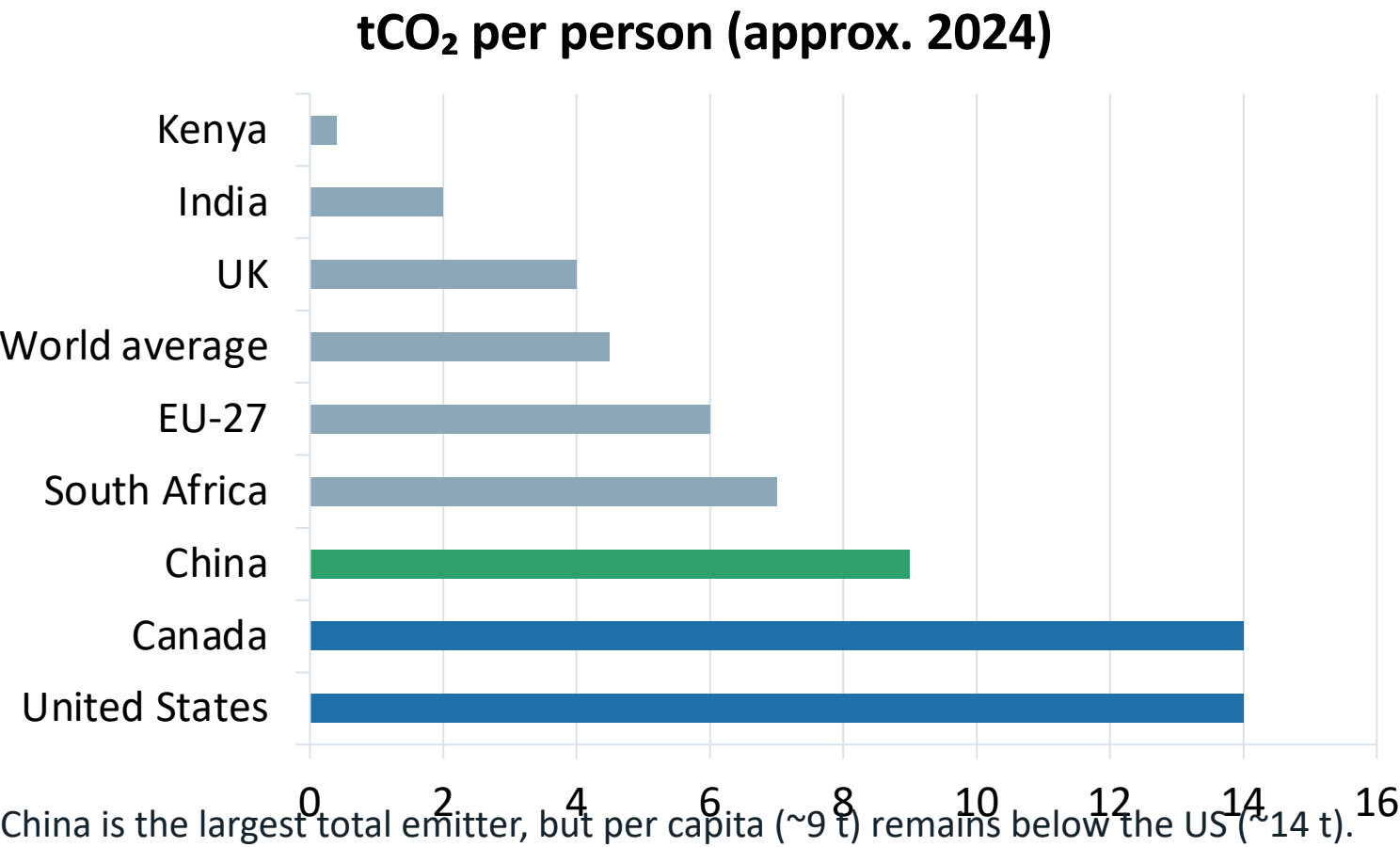
Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Can



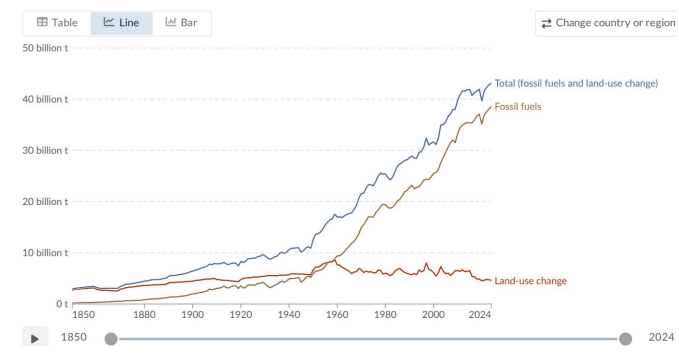
Even among wealthy nations, Europe (e.g., UK ~4 t) is much lower than the US.

Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 (via Our World in Data)

Per Capita Emissions Vary Widely: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China and ~2

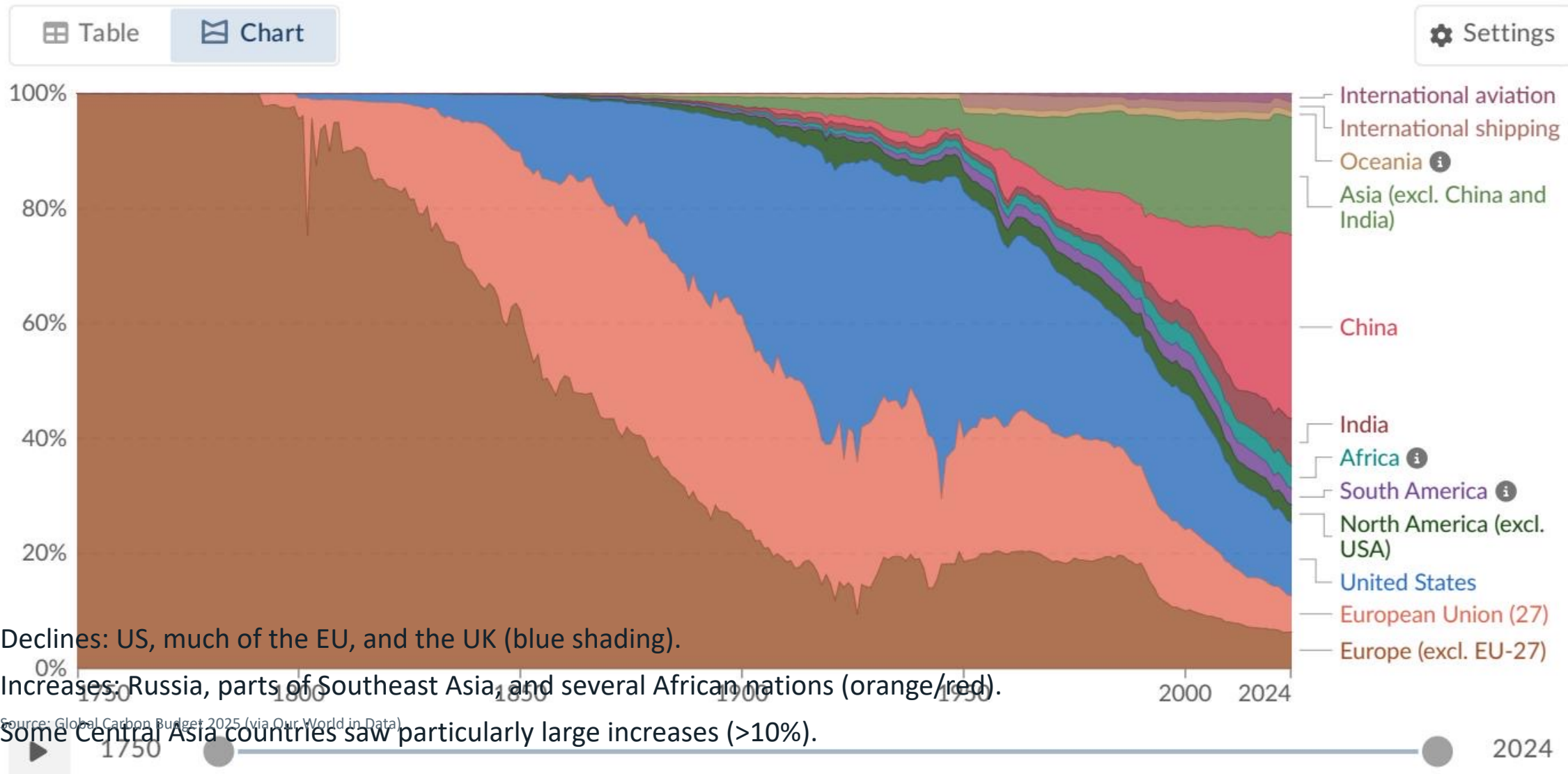


China is the largest total emitter, but per capita (~9 t) remains below the US (~14 t).
India remains very low (~2 t) relative to the world average (~4.5 t).

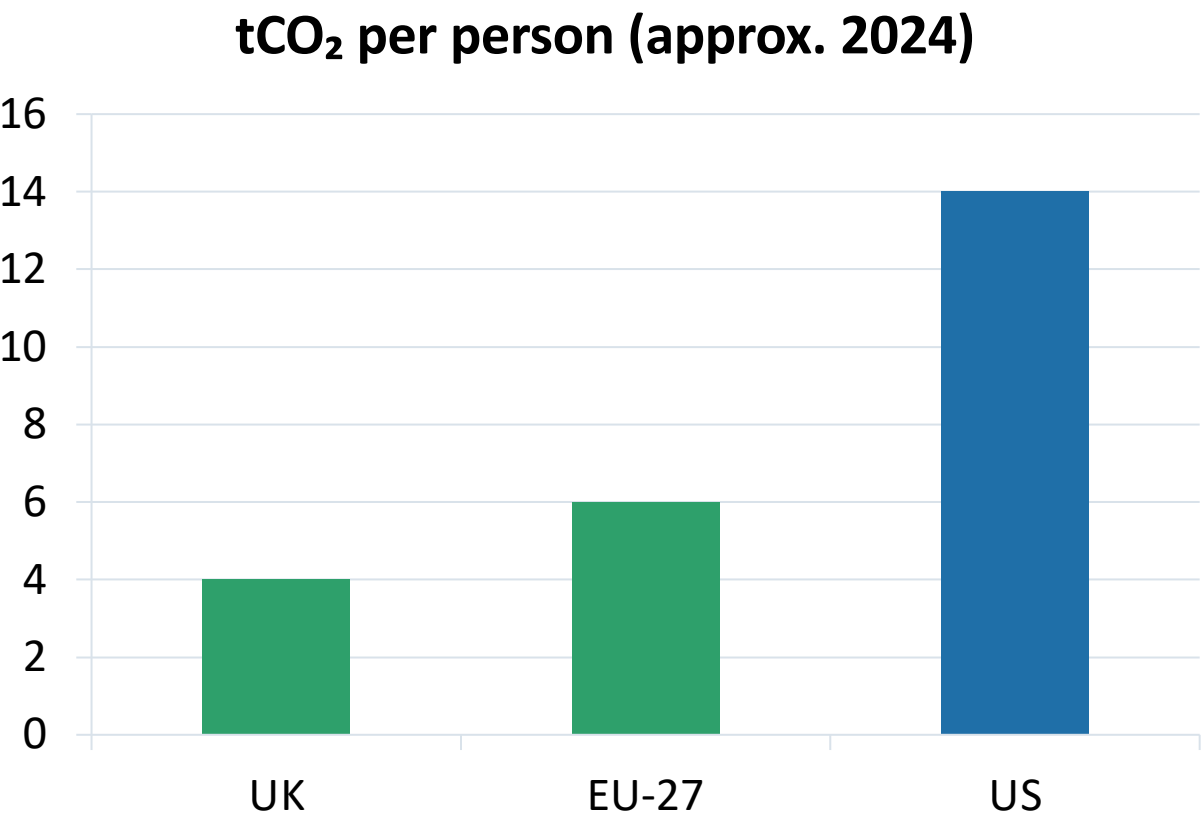


Right: figure_8.jpg (per-capita over time) • Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 (via Our World in Data)

2024 Snapshot: Many Western Nations Cut Emissions While Parts of Asia



Energy Mix Explains Why France and the UK Emit Far Less Per Capita Than the US



Interpretation (qualitative)

Among similarly wealthy countries, per-capita emissions differ substantially.
France, the UK, and Portugal are lower than Germany, the Netherlands, or the US
largely because more electricity comes from nuclear + renewables (less fossil fuel use).

Policy lever: decarbonize power + electrify end uses to reduce per-capita emissions without reducing living standards.

Key Takeaways: Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

Global CO₂ emissions exceed 35 Bt/yr and have not yet peaked (despite slowing growth).

China is the largest annual emitter (~31%), but per capita (~9 t) is still below the US (~14 t).

Historical responsibility: Europe + US dominated (>90% in 1900), but now account for < one-third.

Per-capita gaps of ~150× persist between the richest and poorest nations.

Energy policy and technology choices can decouple prosperity from emissions.

Data

Global Carbon Budget 2025

Via

Our World in Data

Scope

Fossil fuels & industry